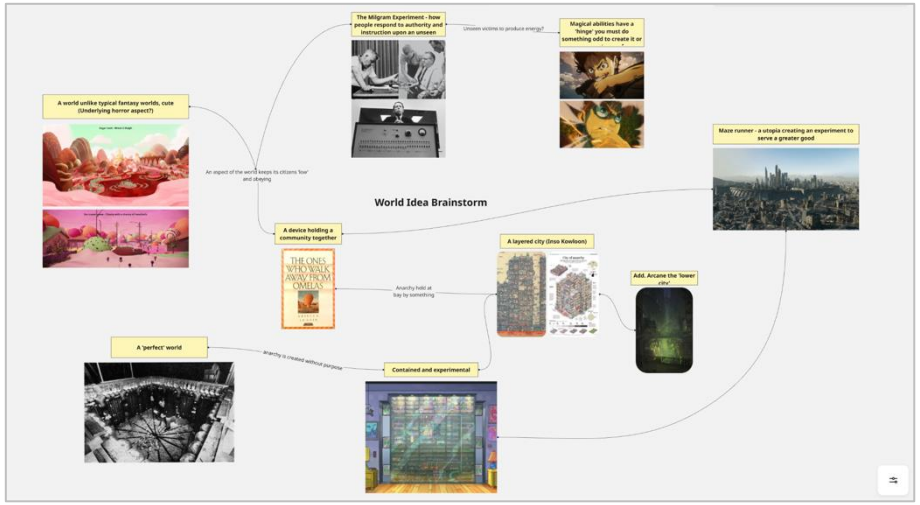
S O M a 1

- The Process journal-

Initial thought experiment - 20/4



In my initial brainstorm, I was targeting things I'm interested in, while trying to stray from typical mainstream fantasy worlds. Though I'm unsure if I succeed respectively. Taking inspiration from multiple sources, e.g., Kowloon, "The ones who walk away", 'The wall' (Solar Opposites), and a few experiments from history. I came away with a pretty solid idea of what I wanted to create going forward. A layered city with a locked-in society.

Ideation - 20/4

When the power goes out

Focusing on a layered world, perhaps in the theme of steam punk, the city then relies heavily on power. Lighting, water systems, technology, transport. Maybe it's not safe to use anything but electricity for power, I could imagine being in an enclosed space with lots of gas powered things, you'd smelt yourself out.

So when the power goes out, someone needs to fix it, there needs to be groups of people for each thing and one is electrical technicians, sparkies, sparks, light, maybe called litins (lit - in's). They would rush to the area of power, imaginably in the center, and figure out what's wrong with the source and fix it.

The surrounding area without power would halt entirely, it would be unsafe to move in the dark even though many are accustomed to doing so, people would be suspended in lifts and trolleys, similar to mine shaft things, and if the issue isn't fixed soon enough they would need help getting down.

This is all under the assumption that the people in this area would get along.

If the city is unpowered for long enough life begins to decay, or adapt.

Free write prompt: What the power goes out.

'What if' chain

What if the city only had one rule?

1. Who created it?
   a. Stewards, Originals, the first inhabitants elected on the way of life after some form of anarchy in the city. They created the rule to create peace of sorts.
2. Does everyone have to follow it or are some exempt?
   a. No. The Stewards exempt themselves by definition and creation of the rule, they are above. The Unseen, the ones outside the city, are exempt. A group of peace keepers, are exempt in order to carry out their duties. (The Lifts - Lifters)
3. What happens if you break it?
   a. What punishment could be worse than death, yet maybe in the place death is seen as a welcoming hand. So it would be harsh and make your life the worst it could be while keeping you alive. The punishment fits the breaker whether that physical pain or mental distress. It must be known what happens else there are rule breakers.

Things to keep:

- Lifters/The lift : A peace keeping power
- Stewards/Originals : the first group locked away
- The Unseen : people outside the city's walls (why are they there? They put the people there)
- A layered hierarchy, both physical in the building and social.

'What if' chain: The city has only one rule?

Here, I prompted myself to try to get a better idea of my layered city and how I wanted it to work. I definitely came to the conclusion that there is a higher power both in and outside the city, and that it is all very controlling. I also began to touch on some physics, i.e., an electrical city.

'Shaping society' experiment - 24/4

Body
It grows, It can die, It learns, Processes ferments and produces

Tree
Creates roots, grows leaves, creates a canopy over time, hoard light

Reef
Creates pressure, flows, is beautifully terrifying dependant, symbiotic or predatory

Machine - Clock
Seizes on the smallest damage

Sediment
Layers over time, crushes, new pushing layers become natural.

Things to happen to cause that change:
Time: Generations, power struggles, clans,
Physical: flood, uprising, rot, humidity
Emotional: despair,
Belief: Cults,

Abandoned.

The shaping society exercise pushed me to stop thinking about the city as a political system and start thinking about it as something alive and decaying simultaneously. Nobody is fully in control. The causes listed (flood, rot, despair, cults, abandonment) suggested that the most interesting things in the city or body are slow pressure and forgotten maintenance. The references I brought in all circle the same question: what happens to people when the system they live inside stops being something they chose?

First Mood board- 20/4





Kowloon





Kowloon Walled City was a largely ungoverned urban enclave in Hong Kong, demolished in 1993. At its peak in 1987, it housed an estimated 33,000 people within just 2.6 hectares. A population density of approximately 1,255,000 inhabitants per square kilometre, making it the most densely populated place in recorded history. It existed in a legal grey zone between British and Chinese jurisdiction, leaving it effectively unregulated, and over time, developed its own internal infrastructure, economy, and community entirely independently of the city around it.

Kowloon Walled City was one of the first things I looked at when I started thinking about what I could make as a lived environment. Though it got demolished in 1993, there's a lot of documentation of it, and I found myself just going through photos for a while.

What I found interesting wasn't the density itself but the fact that it functioned. There were dentists and food stalls and schools and a community in there; it had developed its own internal logic. The outside had essentially locked it away, and it had responded by becoming self-sufficient. Which is obviously very directly relevant to my original pathway of ideas, maybe more than anything else I've looked at.

I think what I'm taking from it is less the aesthetics, though the layered, improvised, no-natural-light quality of it is definitely in my head when I imagine the lower floors of my city, and more the idea that people will organise themselves into something liveable under almost any conditions. The question is just who ends up with the power to decide what livable means. In Kowloon, that was complicated and contested.

I'm also wary of leaning too heavily on it as inspiration, given it's a real place with real history that isn't mine, so I'm trying to take the structural logic rather than reproduce the look of it directly.

‘The Wall’ ~ Solar opposites



The Wall is a recurring subplot in the animated series *Solar Opposites*, in which one of the alien characters uses a shrink ray on humans and stores them inside a terrarium built into the wall of their house. Over time, the trapped humans form their own society entirely from scratch, developing government, economy, class structure, revolution, and collapse, all within a confined space and largely unobserved by the aliens who put them there.

I came across The Wall while trying to find examples of enclosed, self-governing societies in fiction that weren't the obvious ones.

What I found useful wasn't really the sci-fi premise but the structure of it, the idea that a society watched from outside, contained without its knowledge, will still organise itself into something with power at the top and people at the bottom. It happens almost automatically. Nobody designs the hierarchy; it just emerges, which felt like the opposite problem to what I wanted to create in my city, where the hierarchy was deliberately designed and enforced. I think having both in my head at once helped me figure out what was specific about what I was trying to do.

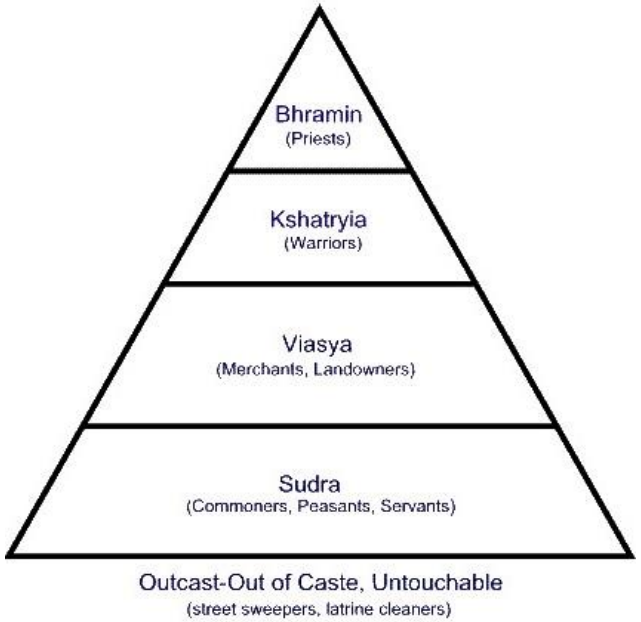
The ‘Caste’ System

A caste system is a form of social stratification in which a person's rank, role, and opportunities are determined by birth and are largely fixed for life. Historically associated with South Asian societies but present in various forms across many cultures, caste systems typically organise people into hereditary groups arranged in a strict hierarchy, where those at the top hold disproportionate power and resources, and those at the bottom are assigned the least valued and most exploitative labour.

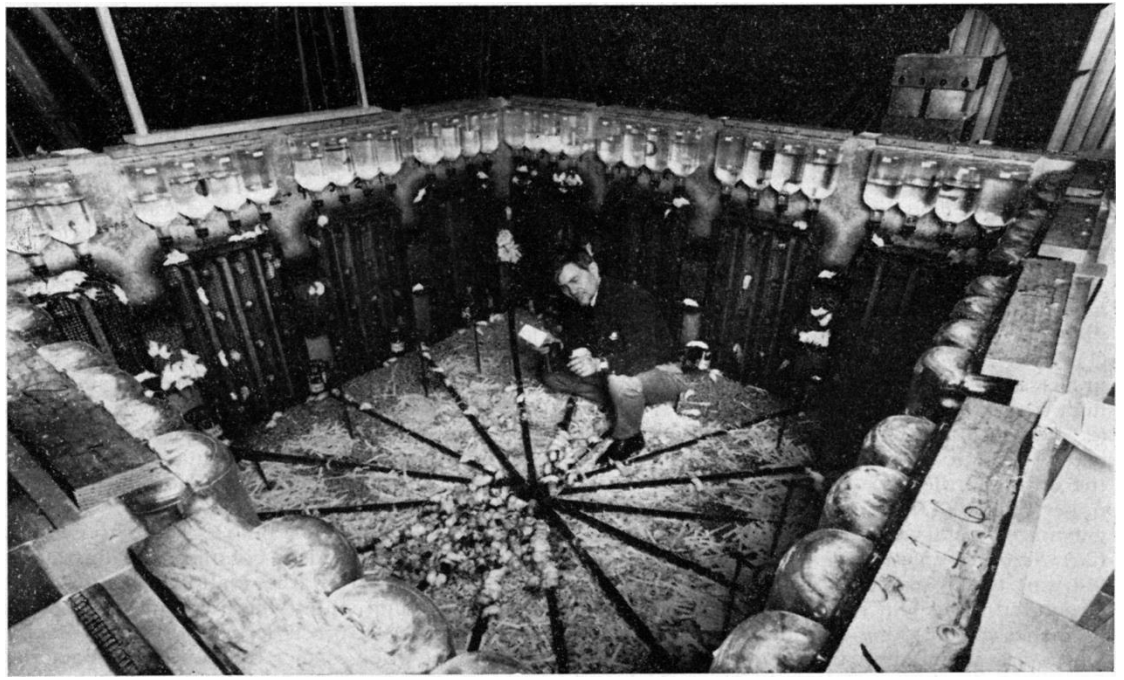
The hierarchy in my city didn't come from nowhere; it came from a question I kept asking while reading about the Castes. What if the solution to meaninglessness or loss of purpose is to assign everyone a meaning, whether they want it or not?

The caste structure emerged from that. I started sketching a building (Pictured next slide) where your floor was your rank. The higher you live, the more you are seen, heard, and felt. The lower you live, the more you become infrastructure. Every apartment block already does a version of this: the penthouse gets the view, the basement gets the pipes. My city removes the fiction that you could ever move between them. Real caste systems (there are many across cultures and history) don't tend to be designed by any one person either. They calcify slowly out of existing hierarchies of labour, visibility, and resource access.

Pictured below is the caste system that is commonly referred to from India.



Universe 25 ~ ‘Mouse Heaven’



Universe 25 was the twenty-fifth iteration of an experiment conducted by American ethologist John B. Calhoun, in which he constructed an enclosed habitat for mice with unlimited food, water, and nesting material and no predators or disease. Beginning in 1968 with four breeding pairs, the population grew rapidly before peaking and then collapsing entirely, not from resource scarcity but from a breakdown of social behaviour, which Calhoun termed the behavioural sink. The experiment ended with the extinction of the population.

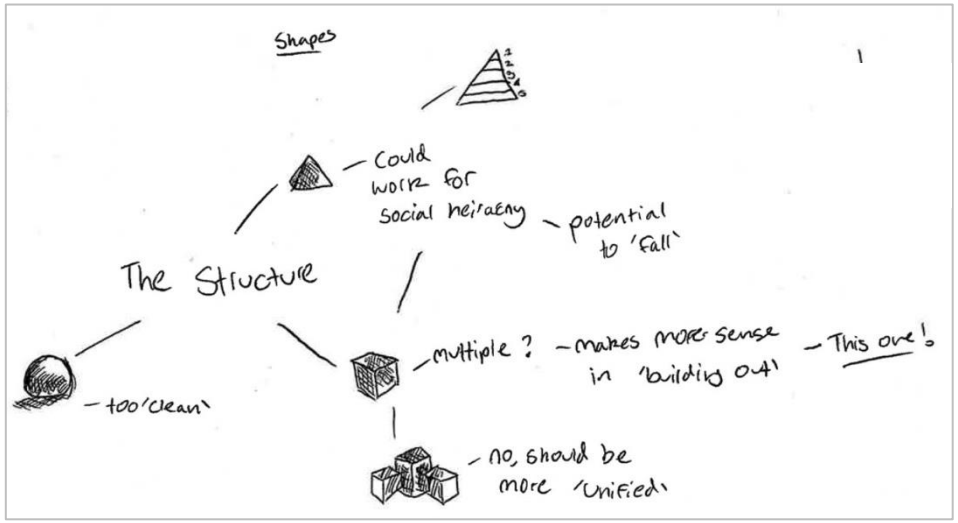
I came across Universe 25 while trying to research enclosed societies and what happens to people when you take away the usual pressures, scarcity, predation, that kind of thing. Calhoun built what was essentially a perfect world for mice. Food unlimited, no disease, no predators, temperature controlled. And they still fell apart, which I found really interesting because the instinct is to assume that if you solve the material problems, everything else follows.

The population peaked at around 2,200 and then just declined, not because of anything running out, but because the social fabric had already gone. Mothers abandoned litters, males either became hyperaggressive or completely withdrew, and there was a group Calhoun called the beautiful ones who just stopped participating entirely. Ate, groomed, slept. Nothing else.

I definitely came away thinking the beautiful ones were the most useful thing for what I'm trying to do with my city. Because the behavioural sink, which is what Calhoun called the point where the dysfunction starts spreading socially rather than just being individual, isn't really about overcrowding, I don't think. It's about a lack of purpose. And that felt like a much more interesting problem to design around.

So the question I kept asking was: what if the people of the city experienced a sink. What if the whole caste structure was a designed response to it, giving everyone a role, a floor, a function, making sure nobody has the option to become a beautiful one?

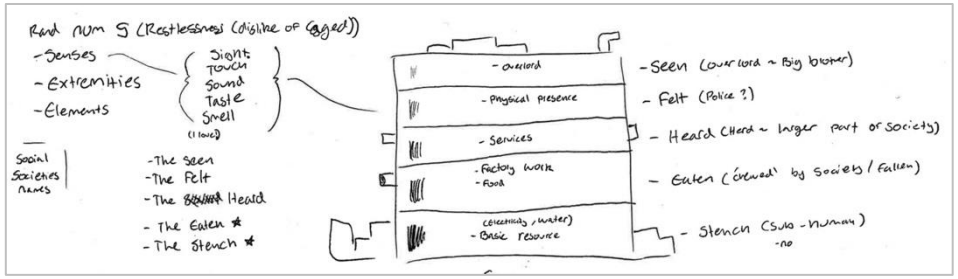
The layers Experimentation 26/4



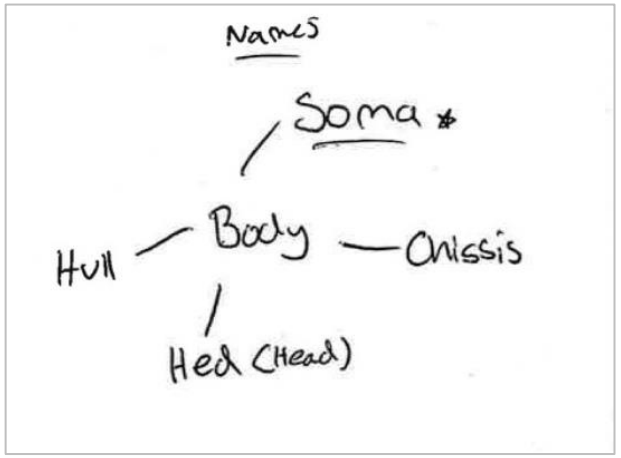
After my first brainstorm, I had a clear vision of what I wanted to make but needed to refine its form. I considered various shapes, such as squares and cubes, drawing inspiration from Kowloon. Building into a cube seemed logical, and I became attached to that form. I briefly explored other shapes; a sphere felt too futuristic and clean, while a pyramid offered strong symbolism of social hierarchy but seemed overused. Ultimately, I preferred the cube.

With the outer shape established, I moved on to conceptualizing the interior. I asked myself: how are these people structured? The 'Shaping society' exercise prompted me to see the place as a 'body,' which heavily influenced my thinking. I used a dice roll to determine five layers of social hierarchy, appreciating the symbolism of the number five as a 'dislike of being caged.' To create cohesive group names for these layers, I drew from my three themes and settled on senses for a more thematic approach.

As I want to have a real 'Big Brother' feel to it, the top layer of society is obviously sight or 'the seen'. Below them, their policing force is touch or 'the felt', as in their presence is felt. Then the middleman, the group that is many of our classes (the middle working class) is Hearing or 'the heard', colloquially known as the 'herd', given they are the greater group. Below is taste, this group has fallen from the ranks of greater society; they have been symbolically eaten and fallen in the ranks. Then finally, smell, or now known as the stench, the lowest of the low.



Naming 26/4



Brainstorming Names for the whole system was pretty simple. As I was already thinking of it as a 'body', finding different words wasn't too hard. Then, picking something that didn't immediately give off those vibes (but still had the meaning) helped me end up at 'Soma'.

While brainstorming names for the system, I was always thinking of what's outside Soma, who put these people here. If soma is the body, its origin is its mother, too kind a title to give. So, Root, the origin of soma is the umbrella term for outsiders.

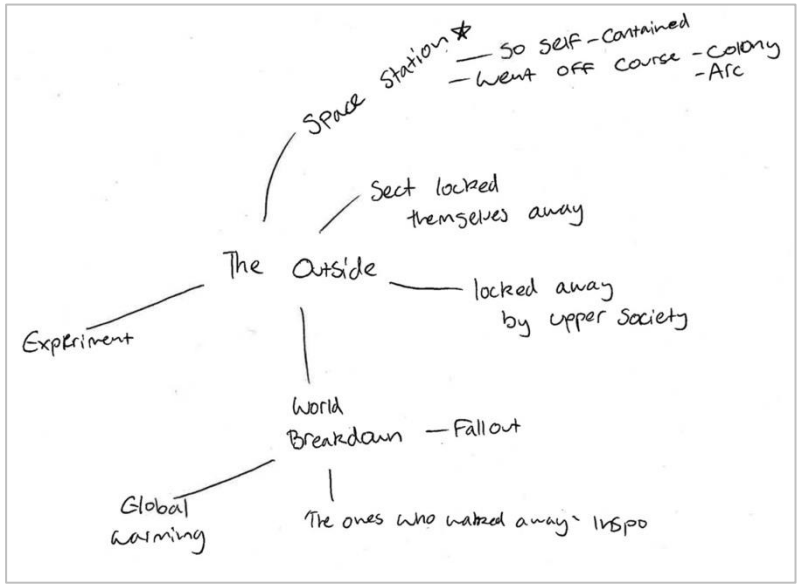
Roles – Ideation 26/4

Keeping the city fully self-contained while being fully running means there must be roles. I mulled over it quite a bit while picking group names and concluded that they must use everything they have – like Dune with water. They could burn their excrement and filter their urine for base sources; these are very 'dirty' jobs, so the stench would oversee those. They would already be set up for some form of farming, perhaps if there were dark times, they would eat each other, but I tend to think they'd be vegetarians. The eaters would take charge of this physical labour.

The middleman, the herd, would attend to general services, anything not related to resource creation, and the upkeep of systems. The Felt are obviously a raised rank of policing forces, and the seen do nothing but rule and manage.

(better description in later slides)

The outside – 26/4



I then came to the task of giving this Soma an origin. Through the primary part of the creation process, I kept the city stuck to the earth; these people were locked away by the greater powers of society, but as I kept paying it mind, it didn't make sense.

A quick brainstorm with a friend certainly helped! Exploring the idea of a world breakdown or nuclear winter was another highly considered idea, as well as Soma being an experiment. However, when space was suggested, it was immediately picked. This makes it easier to explain why people do not leave this city, no longer inspired by 'the ones who walk away from Omelas'; these people legitimately cannot walk away.

Carving out less of a narrative and more of a history or origin, we concluded that **Soma was a highly revered arc mission to bring life to new worlds.** They lost their way to their destination and have been stranded in space. Luckily, they are already completely self-contained.

To get to the hierarchy and big brother aspect they find themselves in, they must have at some point experienced anarchy before they created peace and order. The senses are born! After peace, they could perhaps form some sort of religion, but I haven't gotten to that yet.

We find the Soma1 vastly into our unseen future millions of years from now.

Below is a basic timeline that helps illustrate some origins and why it's in space.

Built → Sent → Lost → Anarchy → Hierarchy → Peace Religion → Current

Soma Systems – 26/04

Dimensions 5km × 5km × 5km cube. Built to house a founding population of 10,000 with capacity for controlled growth up to 50,000. Current population unknown, records have not been independently verified in six generations. Estimated 35,000–40,000.

Construction Soma 1 was not built on Earth. It was assembled in low orbit over approximately fourteen years using modular panel sections launched in stages and bolted into the cube framework from the inside out. The interior was fitted floor by floor as the outer hull was completed around it. The founding population boarded in sections as each floor became habitable. By the time the final hull panels were sealed, the lowest floor had already been occupied for three years.

The Floors

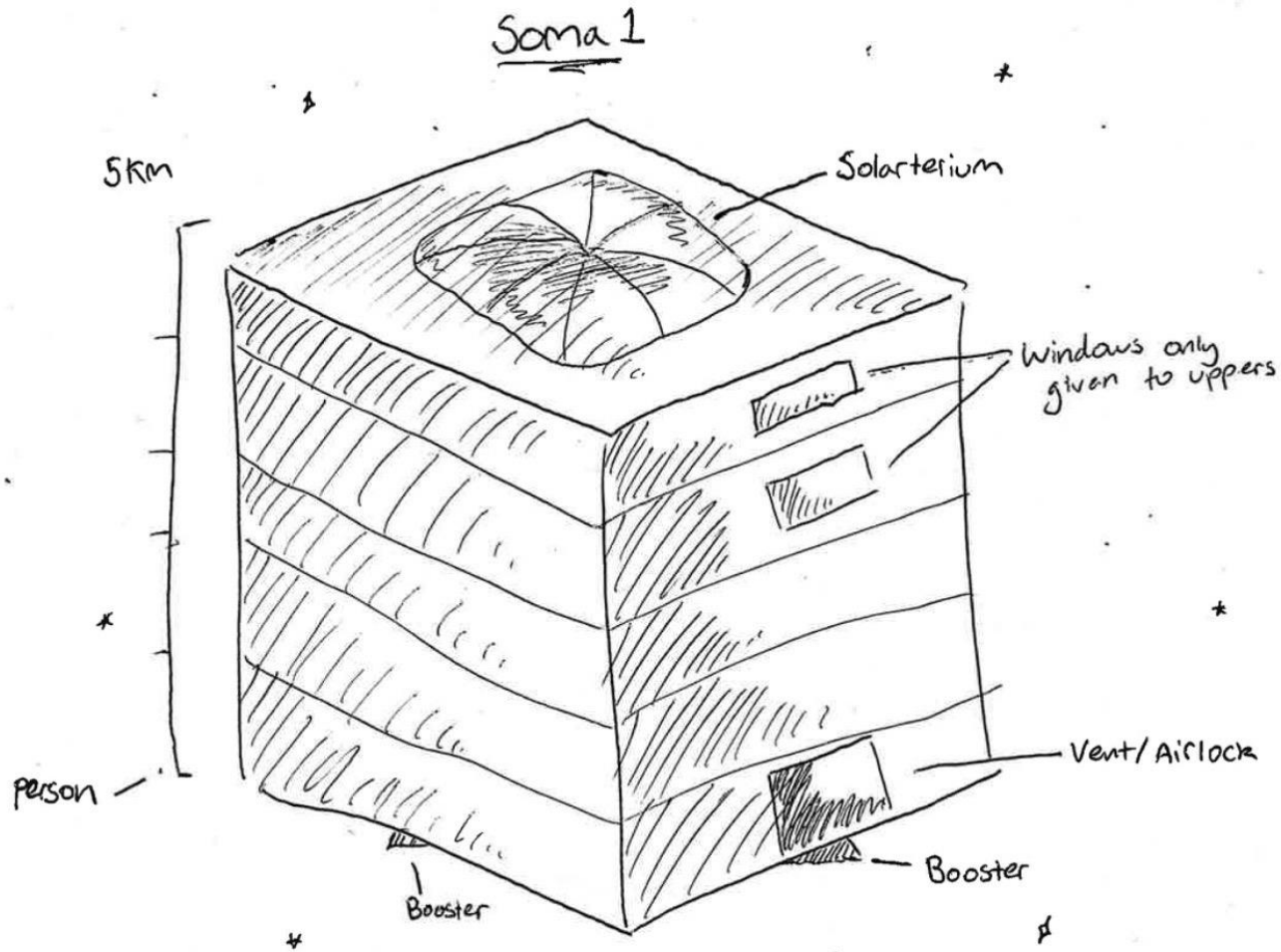
- **Floor 5: Governance** Surveillance infrastructure, administrative chambers, the original launch archive. The Solarterium sits directly above. Highest air quality, highest light levels, and largest individual space allocations on the ship.
- **Floor 4: Enforcement & Administration:** Detention corridor, communication hub, broadcast equipment, the ship's internal clock mechanism, transit pass processing. All inter-floor pressure doors are controlled from this level.
- **Floor 3: Residential & Services** Mixed habitation and service functions, medical, upper systems maintenance, storage of processed rations before distribution.
- **Floor 2: Production** Full-spectrum hydroponic grow stations running on artificial light cycles. Fungal bays in the low-light eastern sections. Food processing facility. Manufacturing workshops. The warmest floor on the ship due to the grow lighting running continuously.
- **Floor 1: Systems:** Excrement combustion units, urine filtration and distillation plant, ventilation control, electrical distribution, hull inspection access points. Built around the ship's infrastructure rather than for its inhabitants. Narrowest corridors, lowest ceilings, and highest ambient noise from the machinery.

Power: The ship launched with four primary fusion reactors intended to run for 200 years. Two failed in the first century. The remaining two run at reduced capacity, cannibalised for parts from the failed units for generations. Combustion of organic waste supplements the power load. The system is stable but has no redundancy left. A second reactor failure would require immediate and severe rationing across all floors.

The Boosters: Eight propulsion boosters are mounted on the base and lower side faces of the hull. Designed for course correction and deceleration on arrival. They have not fired in over two centuries. Officially, they are in standby. Internal assessment, never passed upward, concludes that three are unrecoverable, four are potentially salvageable with significant resource allocation, and one may still function. Nobody has been asked to find out.

The Airlock: A single airlock on the lower south face of Floor 1. Originally designed for external maintenance access and emergency egress. Currently used exclusively for waste ejection, materials that cannot be composted, burned, or filtered are compacted and expelled on a scheduled cycle. It has not been used for human exit or entry since the ship lost course. Whether it could be is not a question anyone aboard is authorised to investigate.

Water & Waste Cycle Fully closed loop. Urine filtered to drinking water, returned upward through the pipe network. Solid waste is dried and burned for power. Organic food waste is composted back into the hydroponic nutrient solution. Nothing leaves the ship except through the scheduled airlock ejection cycle. It is the one system aboard Soma 1 that has never failed.



Religion

No single faith. We want subservience and work, not worship and devotion. Several small sects have developed independently across the floors, largely without the knowledge or acknowledgement of the upper castes. They are not banned, just ignored, which the Seen consider more effective than persecution.

Common themes across the sects:

- **The Outside as Paradise**: the most widespread belief in the lower floors. The Outside is somewhere good, somewhere light reaches, somewhere you could breathe air that hasn't already been breathed. Nobody alive has seen it.
- **The Outside as punishment**: a minority view, more common in the middle floors. The Outside is where you go when the ship casts you out. It is not a place, it is an ending!
- **The Stench**: a fringe cult that has elevated the stench specifically. The logic is straightforward: if the ship is a body, and the stench is its breath and blood, then the stench is more essential than those who govern. This sect is the one the Seen actually watch. It is the only religious movement with political implications.

The Seen are occasionally mythologized in the lower floors as omniscient and possibly not human. This is inaccurate but not entirely irrational, given that lower-floor inhabitants have never seen one and know them only through The Felt.

Society

Floors 4–5
Quiet and controlled. The upper floors have the Solarterium light filtered down through panelled ceilings, the closest thing to daylight anyone aboard experiences. Spaces are larger here, not luxurious, but uncrowded. There is privacy. There is enough food, served fresh. The Seen and The Felt do not want for anything the ship can provide.

Floor 3–4
Functional. The Heard live and work in the administrative corridors of the middle floors, lit, ventilated, and adequately fed. They are the most informed people on the ship, which gives them a particular kind of anxiety nobody else has.

Floor 2
Loud, warm, and permanently lit by the grow station lamps running on their artificial cycle. The Eaten work in shifts, the light doesn't change between day and night, so neither do the shifts, really; they just rotate. The air smells of soil and green things, which is either pleasant or suffocating depending on how long you've been breathing it. It is the most physically active floor on the ship. It is also the most surveilled, because food production is the one piece of leverage the lower floors theoretically hold.

Floor 1
Dark. Hot near the combustion units, cold everywhere else. Shifts are long, and the work is physical, and the floor receives the last of everything, last rations, last heat allocation, last light. The corridors are narrow, built around the ship's pipe and duct infrastructure rather than for the people maintaining it. There are no windows on Floor 1. There are no windows anywhere on Soma 1 below Floor 4, except the Solarterium on the roof, which The Stench has never seen.

Seasons

There are no seasons on board. There is an internal body clock only tracked by the movement of basic and remaining machinery. People sleep when they must as long as they get their work done.

Food and Farming

All food is grown on Floor 2 by The Eaten in fully enclosed indoor farming stations. The model is close to what early Mars colonisation proposals outlined: vertical grow racks under artificial full-spectrum lighting on timed cycles, the ship no longer has. Plants don't know they're in space! They just need the right light, the right nutrients, the right CO_2 levels, and they grow.

Everything must be used!

Lighting is the critical variable. The grow stations run on a strict electrical budget managed by the herd. When power is rationed (which it is, regularly, in the lower levels), the grow lights are the last thing cut. Food production is the one area where the eaten have implicit leverage and knowledge.

The upper floors eat fresh produce. The lower floors eat processed rations, the same crops, compressed, preserved, and portioned centrally by The Heard and distributed by The Felt.

Creatures

No living animals aboard, the was none at launch and none since. The archive holds images, biological records, behavioural documentation, everything the ship's original designers thought worth preserving. Something that existed on a planet nobody alive has seen.

Punishment and Rulings

Punishment on Soma 1 is restriction, resources are the only currency that matters so resources are the only thing taken.

- **Minor infraction**: ration reduction. One tier down from your floor's standard allocation, for a set number of cycles.
- **Moderate infraction**: light restriction. Your personal quarters go dark outside working hours. On the lower floors this is significant. On Floor 1 it is barely distinguishable from normal.
- **Serious infraction**: floor reassignment downward. One floor. Permanent. Your caste designation updates in the record. Your family does not follow unless they choose to, and choosing to is itself logged.
- **Severe infraction**: reassignment to the maintenance corridors below Floor 1. Off the population record entirely. Technically still alive. Not officially.

Politics – The Rule

One rule: maintain the ship.

The Seen set directives. The Felt enforce them. The Heard communicate them downward. Nothing moves upward. There is no appeals process, no assembly, no vote. Transgression results in reassignment to the floor below. There is no mechanism for moving up, except for potential for the heard to become the felt. The threat of descent maintains order. Those who resist entirely are relocated to the maintenance corridors of the lowest level and removed from the official population record.

Jobs and Roles

The Seen: Floor 5

- Surveillance: Monitor all camera feeds across every floor below. Issue reassignment orders based on behaviour and productivity reports.
- The Law: Maintain and update the ship's founding rule and all procedural addenda accumulated around it. Only caste with access to original launch records.

The Felt: Floor 4

- Enforcement: Patrol floors 3 and below on rotation. Carry out physical reassignments, moving individuals between floors when ordered by The Seen.
- Access Control: Operate all pressure doors and airlocks between floors. They decide who moves and when.

The Heard: Floors 3–4

- Record Keeping: Log all births, deaths, reassignments, and infractions. Maintain the population record and distribute ration allocations per floor.
- Communication: Operate the ship's internal broadcast and inter-floor messaging. The only caste permitted to travel between floors. logged every time, pass required.
- Timekeeping: Maintain the ship's internal clock. The only official measure of time aboard Soma 1.

The Eaten: Floor 2

- Farming: Operate the hydroponic grow stations and fungal bays. Monitor nutrient levels, light cycles, and humidity. Harvest and process all food into ration blocks for distribution upward.
- Manufacturing: Produce replacement parts, textiles, and tools. Everything the ship needs that can be made internally.

The Stench: Floor 1

- Power: Collect all excrement ship-wide, dry and burn it in the combustion units on Floor 1. This thermal energy runs the ship's generators. The ship runs on what everyone else discards.
- Water: Run urine through multi-stage filtration and sterilisation. The resulting clean water is piped upward and distributed to every floor. Every drop of water on Soma 1 has been someone's urine. This is known. It is not discussed.
- Hull & Air: Inspect the structural interior for fractures and maintain the ventilation network throughout the ship. The only inhabitants who ever get close to the outer walls. Or get to use the vent/airlock to throw out proper waste (rare as everything can be repurposed)

Narrative Potential

A novel told in five parts, one per floor, same week, same ship. Five entirely different realities occurring simultaneously. The reader assembles what actually happened. No single narrator has the full picture.

A short story following a Stench engineer during a routine hull inspection who finds something on the interior of the ship that the official record says cannot be there. She has to decide whether to report it, to whom, and what reporting it will cost her.

A tabletop game where players are assigned castes at random at the start and must achieve their floor's collective objective. The Eaten keep everyone fed while managing a failing grow light; The Stench keep the ship running on a shrinking power budget; The Heard maintain the information flow while deciding what to pass up and what to bury. Floors don't communicate directly. Everything goes through The Heard, who are also players.

A graphic novel following a child born on Floor 2 who is reassigned to Floor 5 at age twelve for a minor infraction, told entirely without dialogue, just the architecture changing around her as she descends.

Family Structure

Family structures on Soma 1 are practical before they are anything else, you pair within your floor. Not because there is a rule against doing otherwise, but because you never meet anyone from another floor. The Heard are the only exception, and they tend to pair with other Heard. Children are registered at birth by the floor's administrative representative and assigned the caste of their floor. There is no ceremony around this. It is paperwork.

Care is collective on the lower floors out of necessity, shifts are long and unpredictable, and a child cannot be left unattended while a parent is in the combustion bay or the grow station. Neighbours raise each other's children in a loose, unspoken rotation. Nobody decided this was how it would work. It just is.

The concept of extended family, exists but is complicated by reassignment. If a parent is moved down a floor for an infraction, the family has a choice: stay, or follow. After a generation or two of this, most families on the lower floors have a complicated relationship with the concept of lineage.

There are no weddings. There are union registrations, filed with the Heard, because registered partnerships affect ration allocation per household.

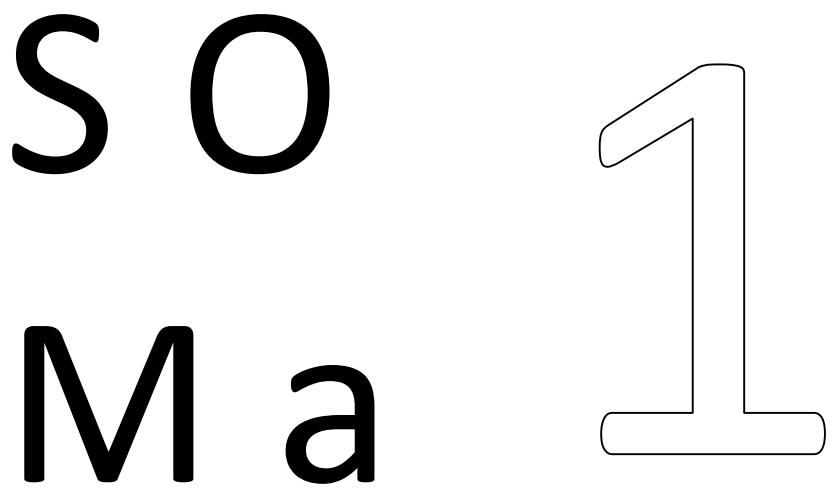
The Creative 'why'

I think I've always been drawn to systems, the way things organise themselves, the way hierarchies form, not because anyone decided they should, but because the conditions made them inevitable. What I wanted to make was a world where you could see that process clearly. Not a fantasy kingdom where power is held by villains, but something more mundane and more honest, a place where the structure is so old that nobody questions it anymore, where the cruelty isn't personal, it's just how things work.

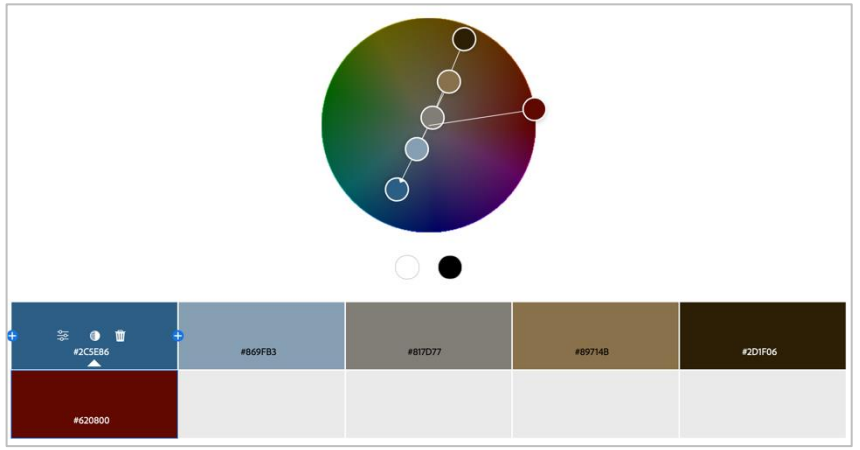
Universe 25 I think gave me the framework, The beautiful ones didn't collapse because of a war or a disaster. They collapsed because the environment stopped offering them anything worth engaging with. I think about what the equivalent looks like in a human society, people going through the motions because the system has made genuine participation impossible. I wanted Soma 1 to sit in that space. A place that functions and that sustains itself indefinitely. That is, by every operational metric, a success. And that is quietly, structurally, doing something terrible to the people inside it.

I'm also aware that the caste structure I've built has resonances with real systems that exist and have existed for people in ways I don't have lived experience of. I've tried to use the logic of hierarchy, without aestheticising any specific cultural version of it. The intention is to make it feel wrong. Whether I've succeeded is something I'd want to keep thinking about as the world develops.

Also, I think this setting would make a great YA novel! Think Maze Runner, Hunger Games, etc, all of the greats certainly had their part in inspiring my interests enough to create Soma.



Colours and symbolism - 28/04



Soma 1 was built optimistically. The original colour language was retro-futurist, deep institutional blues and cold silvers, the visual vocabulary of a civilisation that believed it was going somewhere. The upper floors still look like that. If the top of the ship still looks like the future, the people below are less likely to ask how long ago it was supposed to arrive.

Everything below has had longer to decay. The middle floors are grey, flat, affectless, neither optimistic nor ruined. Below that, the browns take over: rust from moisture on ageing infrastructure, organic matter from decades of proximity to the combustion and composting systems, the colour that accumulates when a surface has been used by human hands for generations without ever being cleaned for appearance. The darkest tone sits at the base, the colour of something that has been burning for a very long time.

The red represents the other, the origin, the root of Soma. Also, a nice stand alone colour for popping details.

Read the palette top to bottom, and you are reading the ship top to bottom. Blue into grey into brown into black into red. The original vision was a silver and blue machine carrying humanity forward.

Seen

Felt

Heard

Eaten

Stench

Root

Bibliography

- BBC. 2019. “What Is India’s Caste System?” *BBC News*, June 19, 2019. https://www.bbc.com/news/world-asia-india-35650616.
- Blakemore, Erin, and Greg Girard. 2025. “Inside Kowloon Walled City—a Lawless Metropolis Where Anarchy Reigned in Hong Kong.” History. May 7, 2025. https://www.nationalgeographic.com/history/article/kowloon-walled-city-history.
- Britannica. 2019. “Hinduism - Castes | Britannica.” In *Encyclopædia Britannica*. https://www.britannica.com/topic/Hinduism/Castes.
- Chan, Angel. 2024. “UCL Asiatic Affairs.” UCL Asiatic Affairs. December 10, 2024. https://www.uclasiaticaffairs.com/publications-list/inspiration-of-dystopian-cyberpunk-the-history-and-culture-of-the-kowloon-walled-citynbsp.
- Crawford, James. 2020. “The Strange Saga of Kowloon Walled City.” Atlas Obscura. January 6, 2020. https://www.atlasobscura.com/articles/kowloon-walled-city.
- Fraser, Alistair, and Eva Cheuk-Yin Li. 2017. “The Second Life of Kowloon Walled City: Crime, Media and Cultural Memory.” *Crime, Media, Culture: An International Journal* 13 (2): 217–34. https://doi.org/10.1177/1741659017703681.
- Kean, Sam. 2022. “Mouse Heaven or Mouse Hell?” Science History Institute. May 17, 2022. https://www.sciencehistory.org/stories/magazine/mouse-heaven-or-mouse-hell/.
- Roos, Dave. 2021. “Kowloon Walled City Once Was the Most Densely Packed Place on Earth.” HowStuffWorks. December 7, 2021. https://history.howstuffworks.com/world-history/kowloon-walled-city.htm.
- Spinoff, NASA. 2024. “Next-Level Farming | NASA Spinoff.” Spinoff.nasa.gov. January 29, 2024. https://spinoff.nasa.gov/Next-Level_Farming.
- to, Contributors. 2025. “The Wall.” Solar Opposites Wiki. Fandom, Inc. 2025. https://solaropposites.fandom.com/wiki/The_Wall.
- Wikipedia Contributors. 2019. “Caste.” Wikipedia. Wikimedia Foundation. January 18, 2019. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Caste.
- ———. 2025. “Solar Opposites.” Wikipedia. Wikimedia Foundation. December 7, 2025. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Solar_Opposites.
- Wiles, Will. 2011. “The Behavioral Sink | Will Wiles.” Cabinetmagazine.org. 2011. https://www.cabinetmagazine.org/issues/42/wiles.php.